

parking lot of the building or simply driving by (war driving), and even someone flying over the building in a plane (war flying). And you can't even trust line-of-sight as a requirement for compromise as hackers, using inexpensive antennas, can tap into your network from over a mile away.

These attackers can capture network traffic, place viruses or other Trojan horse hacker tools on local computers, and even send spam out to the Internet through the unprotected WLAN. So, how do the bad guys take advantage of unprotected WLANs? It's very simple—they exploit various well-known vulnerabilities that make WLANs susceptible to attack.

Protecting against vulnerabilities is not simple. Rather than just making one or two simple configuration changes, there are literally dozens of changes—often very technical in nature—that must be made to WLAN devices to harden them from most of these attacks.